

COMMENTS ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ACTION PLAN

March 13, 2025
(Corrected)

The Global Data Alliance (GDA)¹ appreciates the opportunity to submit the comments to the Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) and the National Science Foundation (NSF) in connection with the Administration's Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan.² We welcome the leadership of OSTP and NSF in advancing this Plan.

The GDA is a cross-industry coalition of companies headquartered and/or having extensive operations across the United States. GDA member companies support tens of millions of well-paying US jobs in all sectors. GDA member companies are active in the aerospace, agriculture, automotive, energy, finance, health, hospitality, insurance, manufacturing, natural resources, publishing, software, supply chain, telecommunications, and transportation sectors. GDA members rely on the ability to access and transfer data across borders to innovate and create jobs.

The GDA urges the US government to [promote cross-border data access to fulfill AI Action Plan goals](#). Cross-border access to, and transfers of, data are critical to sustaining and enhancing America's AI-driven economic competitiveness and national security. We recommend a whole-of-government approach that promotes the free and responsible flow of data, and – where appropriate – interoperable data transfer mechanisms. Such an approach can leverage existing US government efforts and tools to promote cross-border data transfers, including at the Office of the US Trade Representative and the Departments of Commerce, State, and Treasury.

DISCUSSION

Consistent with the January 2025 Executive Order on [Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence](#), cross-border access to, and transfers of, data are critical to meeting the AI Action Plan goals of promoting progress in the sciences, technology, and in the development of new products, services, and economic opportunities. US job creators are increasingly developing and deploying AI tools across their operations, as are US science- and innovation-oriented organizations. The success of these efforts to develop and deploy AI at scale depends, first and foremost, on the application of computational data analytics techniques to data sourced globally.

From developing predictive models to deploying and using analytical solutions, data analytics systems are “trained” by ingesting large global data sets to identify underlying patterns, relationships, and trends that are then transformed into mathematical models that can make predictions based on new data inputs. As outlined in the Annex, these data sets often originate from geographically dispersed sources across transnational digital networks, making it imperative that data can move seamlessly and securely across borders. To secure the insights and other benefits that data analytics can provide, it is important to work with partner governments to avoid impediments to data access on improper grounds (i.e., on grounds that are arbitrary, discriminatory, disguised, or unnecessary).

Smart and responsible deployment of AI tools, supported by data inputs from across the globe, can help advance improvements in healthcare, modernize education, increase business productivity and competitiveness, and strengthen cybersecurity and national security.

To promote AI-driven advances in science, technology, and the economy, the United States should engage with allied economies to ensure that US cross-border access to data is not improperly impeded through foreign government data transfer barriers that are arbitrary, discriminatory, disguised, or unnecessary. Please do not hesitate to reach out with any questions or comments.

Sincerely yours,

Joseph P. Whitlock

Executive Director
Global Data Alliance

ANNEX

Illustrative List of AI Applications that Depend Upon Cross-Border Access to Data

We offer below a few (widely recognized) examples of insights, predictions, and other outputs derived from computational analysis in the machine learning context of data derived from transnational sources:

- Automated flight management and air traffic control based on computational analysis of meteorological conditions, real-time fuel consumption, aircraft operational data, nearby air traffic conditions, airport congestion, and numerous other data elements across international airspace and global aviation assets.³
- Identification of chemical and cellular anomalies across global population groups for early diagnosis, prevention, and treatment in the fields of oncology, autoimmune disorders, and Parkinsons and Alzheimer's disease.⁴
- By integrating AI and automation into data and network security operations, organizations can leverage global, real-time security data to enhance threat detection and response. Since AI relies on vast amounts of high quality globally diverse data to be effective, this approach improves the identification of security anomalies and the mitigation of potential threats.
- Predictive climate modeling based on computational analysis of satellite data, weather station data, topographical information, and various IoT and sensor data from around the world.⁵
- Improved carbon tracking and mitigation based on computational analysis of transportation logs, meter readings, fuel purchase records, atmospheric pollution tracking, and visual monitoring of power plants and other facilities, and other data sources from different countries and regions.⁶
- Computational analysis to map vulnerable seaside areas to produce cyclone risk maps and guide investment plans for cyclone shelters, schools, health facilities, and other infrastructure for disaster planning and survivability.⁷
- Predictive typing and other office productivity solutions (e.g., an “auto-complete” function that suggests the letters “...cerely yours” after the typist inputs the letters, “sin”),⁸ or the creation of sound effects or special effects to assist creators and film producers in developing new artworks.⁹

¹ The GDA is a cross-industry coalition of companies that are committed to high standards of data responsibility and that rely on the ability to access and transfer information across borders to innovate and create jobs in the United States. For more information, see <https://www.globaldataalliance.org>

² Office of Science & Technology Policy, *Public Comment Invited on Artificial Intelligence Action Plan* (Feb. 25, 2025), at: <https://www.whitehouse.gov/briefings-statements/2025/02/public-comment-invited-on-artificial-intelligence-action-plan/> See also, Office of the Federal Register, *Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan* (Feb. 6, 2025), at: <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/02/06/2025-02305/request-for-information-on-the-development-of-an-artificial-intelligence-ai-action-plan>

³ See e.g., M. Durgut, *Artificial Intelligence and Air Traffic Control*, Aviationfile.com website (Jan. 2023), at: [https://www.aviationfile.com/artificial-intelligence-and-air-traffic-control/#:~:text=One%20of%20the%20primary%20applications%20is%20to%20help,make%20informed%20decisions%20on%20routing%20and%20scheduling%20flights;Degas%20et%20al.,A%20Survey%20on%20Artificial%20Intelligence%20and%20explainable%20AI%20in%20Air%20Traffic%20Management,12%20Applied%20Sciences%201295%20\(2022\),at%3Ahttps%3A%2F%2Fwww.mdpi.com%2F2076-3417%2F12%2F3%2F1295;Hanneke%20Weitering,How%20Artificial%20Intelligence%20is%20Transforming%20Aviation,Futureflight.aero%20website%20\(2023\),at%3Ahttps%3A%2F%2Fwww.futureflight.aero%2Fnews-article%2F2023-07-13%2Fbeyond-automation-how-artificial-intelligence-transforming-aviation](https://www.aviationfile.com/artificial-intelligence-and-air-traffic-control/#:~:text=One%20of%20the%20primary%20applications%20is%20to%20help,make%20informed%20decisions%20on%20routing%20and%20scheduling%20flights;Degas%20et%20al.,A%20Survey%20on%20Artificial%20Intelligence%20and%20explainable%20AI%20in%20Air%20Traffic%20Management,12%20Applied%20Sciences%201295%20(2022),at%3Ahttps%3A%2F%2Fwww.mdpi.com%2F2076-3417%2F12%2F3%2F1295;Hanneke%20Weitering,How%20Artificial%20Intelligence%20is%20Transforming%20Aviation,Futureflight.aero%20website%20(2023),at%3Ahttps%3A%2F%2Fwww.futureflight.aero%2Fnews-article%2F2023-07-13%2Fbeyond-automation-how-artificial-intelligence-transforming-aviation)

- ⁴ See e.g., Hunter et al., *The Role of Artificial Intelligence in Early Cancer Diagnosis*, 14(6) *Cancers* 1524 (2022), <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8946688/>; Stafford et al., *A systematic review of the applications of artificial intelligence and machine learning in autoimmune diseases*, 3 *NPJ - Digital Medicine* 30 (2020), at: <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41746-020-0229-3>; Diogo et al., *Early diagnosis of Alzheimer's disease using machine learning*, 14 *Alzheimers Research and Theory* 107 (2022), at: <https://alzres.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/s13195-022-01047-y>; Ahsan et al., *Machine-Learning-Based Disease Diagnosis: A Comprehensive Review*, 10(3) *Healthcare Basel* 541 (2022), at: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8950225/>; Luchini et al., *Artificial Intelligence in Oncology*, 126 *British J. of Cancer* 1 (2022), at: <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41416-021-01633-1>; Yumar et al., *Artificial intelligence in Disease Diagnosis*, 14(7) *J. Ambient Intell Humaniz Comput.* 8459 (2023), at: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8754556/>
- ⁵ Schneider et al., *Harnessing AI and computing to advance climate modelling and prediction*, 13 *Nature Climate Change* 887 (2023), at: <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41558-023-01769-3>; World Economic Forum, *The role of machine learning in helping to save the planet* (2021), at: <https://www.weforum.org/agenda/2021/08/how-is-machine-learning-helping-us-to-create-more-sophisticated-climate-change-models/>; Kaak et al., *Aligning artificial intelligence with climate change mitigation*, 12 *Nature Climate Change* 518 (2022), at <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41558-022-01377-7>; Xin et al., *Artificial Intelligence for Climate Change Risk Prediction, Adaptation, & Mitigation*, *Ecological Processes* (2021), at: <https://www.springeropen.com/collections/AICC>; Chantry et al., *Opportunities and challenges for machine learning in weather and climate modelling*, 379 *Phil. Trans. R. Soc.* 83 (2020), at: <https://doi.org/10.1098/rsta.2020.0083> (2020).
- ⁶ See e.g., Global Data Alliance, *Cross-Border Data Transfers & Environmental Sustainability* (2023) (internal citations omitted), at: <https://globaldataalliance.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/04/04192023gdacbdtsustainability.pdf>
- ⁷ See *id.*
- ⁸ See e.g., S. Ashraf, *Desmystifying Autocomplete*, *Towards Data Science* (2020), at: <https://towardsdatascience.com/index-48563e4c1572>; A. Wickramarachchi, *Machine Learning: Word Embedding and Predicting*, *Towards Data Science* (2020), at: <https://towardsdatascience.com/machine-learning-word-embedding-and-predicting-e603254e4d7b>
- ⁹ See e.g., D. Nelson, *AI Researchers Design Program To Generate Sound Effects For Movies and Other Media*, *Unite AI Website* (2022), <https://www.unite.ai/ai-researchers-design-program-to-generate-sound-effects-for-movies-and-other-media/>